



جُذُورٌ تَقْرَأُ

THE JUTHUR PROJECT

JUTHUR PRESS · مَطْبَعَةُ جُذُور

MASTER VOLUME I · PHONETIC FOUNDATION



Master Volume 1 — Phonetic Foundation

الدُّكْتُورُ عَادِلُ ف. عَامِر · Dr. Adel F. Amer

Juthur · Tactile Reading (TRT) · Amer, 2024 · ORCID 0009-0008-9618-3863



· M M X X I V ·



COVER & GUIDING PHILOSOPHY

The Juthur (جُثُور) (Amer, 2024) Project · Roots of Sensation — “The letter is known through the intersection of the senses, and language through the multiplicity of context.”

Phonetic Foundation · The Foundational Level · Early Years · Ages 4–5.

The eleven letters of the volume: alif, waw, ya, ba, ta, mim, kaf, dal, ra, lam, nun.

Eleven letters — each letter a friend that lives within your body.

Authored by Dr. Adel F. Amer · ORCID 0009-0008-9618-3863 · First Qaz'i (nascent) Level · Roots of Sensation (Green).



THE JOURNEY OF SOUNDS

In prolongation (Madd) the friends who discover sound — Aya, Wa'eil, and Yara — come together; in the consonants the letters speak for themselves, each a friend whispering its secret to you. Two sounds, one journey: your body spells the letter before your eye does. Stretch your arm and you know “ā”; press your lips then release and you know “b.”

Prolongation (Madd): alif · waw · ya.

Consonants: ba · ta · mim · kaf · dal · ra · lam · nun.



GUIDE FOR THE FACILITATOR AND PARENT

Read the sound of the letter calmly, then physically practise the Mirsah (المِرْسَاة) (Amer, 2024) — the sensory anchor — together as an action. During the Question's Silence, stay silent with the child, without filler. The golden rule: "Do not describe to him what he is about to feel; let him feel, then describe."

A psychomotor–affective level: Simpson (psychomotor domain), Krathwohl (affective domain), Ehri (pre-alphabetic phase), Ayres, and Versteegh. It claims neither CEFR nor Bloom — we are in the domain "before symbolic communication."

The "Question's Silence" lasts 2–3 seconds at most — a long silence unsettles the young child. Each letter has a bridging action that carries the sound into the home.

The English line is for non-Arabic-speaking parents (Arabic being a heritage language), to guide the bridging action — it is not a text for the child.



STATION 1 . PROLONGATION (MADD) — EXTENSION

Aya raises her hands. "Āāā..." The sound lengthens with the outstretched arm and does not break. She opens her arms like a great door, and the sound lengthens along with them.

The child places his palm on his chest to feel his pulse, then slowly raises his arm with each beat. "Let your arm lengthen... notice how it extends."

What changed in the sound when it lengthened? And what happened to your pulse?



Ā.. ā.. who lengthens? ā.. I lengthen. — Two arms stretched upward with each “ā.”

A word to inhale: bāb (door). Trace the long stroke of “alif” in the sand tray with your finger, and hang its trace on the wall of memory.

Articulation: wide opening of the mouth, lowering of the palate, flattening of the tongue. · Signalling action: stretch your arms like a door opening to the sky and say āāā. · Discovering meaning: what thing opens like your arms? · Alternatives: whispered version (voiceless, shorter prolongation); rhythm tap (three quick prolongations with a jump).

For non-Arabic parents: Stretch your arms up like a door opening to the sky. Say: Aaaa.



STATION 2 · PROLONGATION (MADD) — ROTATION

Wa’eil moves his hand in a circle and says: “Www...” His hand turns and the sound turns with it, slow and calm, like a swing that revolves and does not stop.

The child places his palm on his chest, then moves his hand in a slow circle before his face. “Let your hand turn... notice how it winds.”

Close your eyes a moment... where is the sound turning now? In your belly or in your chest?

Ww.. ww.. who turns? Ww.. I turn. — A hand winding a circle with each “ww.”

A word to inhale: nūr (light). Draw the circle of “waw” in the sand, and keep its trace in the satchel of memory.



Articulation: rounding of the lips into a small circle; the sound emerges rounded. · Signalling action: move your hand in a circle and say wwwww, like the wind winding around the house. · Discovering meaning: what thing winds around you like your hand? · Alternatives: whispered version (smaller, slower circle); rhythm tap (a full body rotation with the sound).

For non-Arabic parents: Move your hand in a circle and say: Ooooo, like the wind turning around the house.



STATION 3 · PROLONGATION (MADD) — SOFTNESS

Yara touches a soft piece of cotton and says: “Yyy...” A light sound that glides, soft beneath her finger, and does not cry out.

The child places his palm on his quiet chest, then rests his finger gently on his lips. “Let your voice soften... soft as silk.”

Let your lips relax... how did your voice come out this time? Light or heavy?

Yy.. yy.. who softens? Yy.. I soften. — A finger on the lip with each “yy.”

A word to inhale: fil (elephant). Draw the soft “ya” in the sand, and remember its softness.

Articulation: raising of the middle of the tongue toward the palate; the sound glides softly. · Signalling action: touch silk or soft cotton and say yyy, light as what you touched. · Discovering meaning: what thing touches your skin gently like your finger? · Alternatives: a very light whisper; rhythm tap (running the hand over a soft surface with the sound).

For non-Arabic parents: Touch something soft like silk and say: Yeeee, light as what you touched.





PLAY STATION · AFTER PROLONGATION — THE PROLONGATION RACE

Each child takes a deep breath, then releases the prolonged sound he loves: “ā” or “w” or “y.” Who can lengthen the sound longest without breaking it? Raise your arms with the sound, and lower them when it runs out. Laughter, not winning!



STATION 4 · CONSONANTS — EXPLOSION

The child presses his lips tightly... then opens them suddenly: “b!” Like a bottle cap when it releases with a small, strong sound.

The child presses his lips tightly (without holding his breath)... then opens them suddenly in one burst. “Press your lips hard... then open all at once.”

Place your palm before your lips... what touches the face of your palm when you sound “b”?

B... b... who bursts free? Bā... I burst free. — Pressing the lips then opening them suddenly with each “b.”

A word to inhale: bābā (papa). Draw “ba” and its dot in the sand, and preserve the trace of the burst.

Articulation: closure of the lips then their bursting with the trapped air. ·

Signalling action: open a closed water bottle; feel the pressure then hear “b!” at the release. · Discovering meaning: what thing bursts suddenly like your lips? ·

Alternatives: a light release with no loud sound; rhythm tap (three bursts with jumps).



For non-Arabic parents: Open a closed water bottle; feel the press, then hear 'b!' as it releases.



STATION 5 · CONSONANTS — TAPPING

The child taps with the tip of his tongue behind his upper teeth: “t... t.” A small, light tap, like one who knocks a door with his finger.

The child taps his finger on a rough sensory material in an even rhythm. “Tap lightly.”

Place your finger behind your teeth... where does your tongue touch when you say “t”?

T... t... who taps? Tā... I tap. — Tapping the finger on the table with each “t.”

A word to inhale: tūt (berries). Draw “ta” and its two dots, and leave the trace of the tapping.

Articulation: striking the tip of the tongue behind the upper teeth in a light tap. ·

Signalling action: knock the room door with light taps “t.. t.” · Discovering meaning: what thing taps like your finger? · Alternatives: a silent tap with the finger only; rhythm tap (fast repeated tapping then a pause).

For non-Arabic parents: Tap the door lightly: t.. t. Where does your tongue tap inside?



STATION 6 · CONSONANTS — RESONANCE

The child presses his lips together (they do not part) and releases a long “mmm.”

The sound resonates in his nose, like a calm humming when he is at ease.



The child closes his lips and places his palm gently on his nose to feel the vibration.
“Close your lips... let the sound resonate in your nose.”

Press your lips together... do you feel the resonance? (In “m” it is the lips, not the tongue.)

M... m... who resonates? Mā... I resonate. — A palm on the nose with each “m.”

A word to inhale: māmā (mama). Draw the rounded “mim,” and remember its resonance.

Articulation: closure of the lips with the sound emerging as a resonance from the nose. · Signalling action: place your hand on a device that gently hums so as to feel a humming like “mmm.” · Discovering meaning: what thing hums and resonates like your nose? · Alternatives: a short light resonance; rhythm tap (humming with a gentle rocking of the body).

For non-Arabic parents: Place your hand on something that gently hums (like a fridge) and feel a buzz like mmmm.



STATION 7 · CONSONANTS — FORCE

The child strikes once with his palm on the table and releases “k!” from the back of his mouth. A strong sound emerging from the back of the mouth, from where the throat begins.

The child strikes a light-yet-strong blow with his palm on the table to feel the guttural force. “Release ‘k’ from the back of your mouth, from where the throat begins.”

Place your palm on your throat... where does “k” come out of your mouth?

K... k... who strikes? Kā... I strike. — A light strike of the palm with each “k.”





A word to inhale: kura (ball). Draw the strong “kaf” in the sand, and preserve its impact.

Articulation: raising of the back of the tongue toward the back of the palate then its separation. · Signalling action: pound spices with a pestle; feel the impact of the blow “k.. k.” · Discovering meaning: what thing strikes forcefully like your palm? · Alternatives: a silent strike with the palm; rhythm tap (two strong strikes then stillness).

For non-Arabic parents: Pound spices with a pestle; feel the strike: ka.. ka.



STATION 8 · CONSONANTS — DESCENT

The child stamps his foot on the ground once and releases “d!” A quick, strong strike, like a foot that comes down and holds firm on the ground.

The child stamps his foot once to feel the weight. “Come down once... and feel the weight.”

Stamp your foot... did the sound land with the foot?

D... d... who comes down? Dā... I come down. — A foot descending with each “d.”

A word to inhale: dubb (bear). Draw “dal” in the sand, and remember its confident landing.

Articulation: striking the tip of the tongue behind the teeth in a voiced strike. · Signalling action: jump down once onto a thick rug and hear “d!” · Discovering meaning: what thing descends and holds firm like your foot? · Alternatives: a tap with the heel instead of a jump; rhythm tap (three descents then stillness).

For non-Arabic parents: Jump down once onto a thick rug and hear: d!





STATION 9 · CONSONANTS — REPETITION

The child shakes his finger quickly before his lips and releases “rrr.” A sound that trembles and repeats, like the wing of a small bird fluttering.

The child shakes his finger quickly before his lips, or blows a swaying puff onto his palm to feel the trembling of the air. “Shake your finger quickly... let the air tremble.”

Place your finger on your lips... do you feel the trembling when you say “r”?

R... r... who quivers? Rā... I quiver. — Shaking the finger quickly with each “r.”

A word to inhale: arnab (rabbit). Draw the trembling “ra,” and preserve its rhythm.

Articulation: repeated trilling of the tip of the tongue behind the teeth. · Signalling action: shake a sieve holding grains (rice) and hear the rattle “r.. r.” · Discovering meaning: what thing quivers and repeats like your tongue? · Alternatives: a light trembling with the finger; rhythm tap (shaking the body together quickly with the sound).

For non-Arabic parents: Shake a sieve with grains and hear the rattle: r.. r.



STATION 10 · CONSONANTS — LATERAL FLOW

The child runs his finger along the sides of his mouth and releases “l...” A sound that glides from the sides of the tongue, soft and unbroken.



The child raises the tip of his tongue to the roof of his mouth and releases “l,” feeling the air flow from the two sides of his tongue. “Raise the tip of your tongue... let the air flow from its sides.”

Raise the tip of your tongue... where does it touch when you say “l”?

L... l... who curves? Lā... I curve. — The tongue-tip to the lip, and the air flowing from its sides with each “l.”

A word to inhale: laban (milk). Draw “lam” in the sand with your finger, and remember how the sound glided from the side.

Articulation: the tip of the tongue adheres to the roof of the mouth, and the sound flows from the two sides of the tongue (a lateral sound). · Signalling action: run your hand along the rim of a round plate and say “l...” · Discovering meaning: what thing glides softly from the side like your voice? · Alternatives: a small arc with the finger; rhythm tap (a large arc with both arms together).

For non-Arabic parents: Trace the rim of a round plate with your hand and say: l...



STATION 11 · CONSONANTS — INNER RESONANCE

The child raises the tip of his tongue to touch the roof of his mouth behind his upper teeth and releases “n.” A sound that resonates in his nose, but it is his tongue that works — not his lips as with “mim.”

The child closes his mouth and places his palm on his nose to feel the inner resonance. “Raise the tip of your tongue to the roof... let the sound resonate.”

Where does your tongue touch in “n”? And where were your lips in “m”?

N... n... who whispers? Nā... I whisper. — The tongue-tip to the roof with each “n.”





A word to inhale: najma (star). Draw “nun” and its dot, and preserve its faint resonance.

Articulation: the tip of the tongue adheres to the base of the upper teeth (not the lips as with “mim”), and the resonance is from the nose. · Signalling action: place your finger behind your upper teeth and say “n” with your mouth almost closed; feel where your tongue touches and where the sound resonates. · Discovering meaning: what thing resonates inside you like “nun”? · Alternatives: a short light resonance; rhythm tap (resonance with a gentle rocking of the shoulders).

For non-Arabic parents: Place your hand on your nose; does it buzz with: nnn?



PLAY STATION · AFTER THE CONSONANTS — THE SILENT LETTER

A child secretly chooses a letter and performs only its movement, without sound: he presses his lips and releases (“b”), or taps with his finger (“t”). The others guess the letter from its movement alone. The body speaks while the voice is silent!



THE OBSERVATION AND TRANSITION CARD

It is recorded by the facilitator (not the child). Criterion for transition: embodiment, not mastery — that the child embodies the sound of most letters and names his sensation.

Embodies the sound of “alif” through its movement and responds to it sensorially.

Embodies the sound of “waw” through its movement and responds to it sensorially.



Embodies the sound of “ya” through its movement and responds to it sensorially.

Embodies the sound of “ba” through its movement and responds to it sensorially.

Embodies the sound of “ta” through its movement and responds to it sensorially.

Embodies the sound of “mim” through its movement and responds to it sensorially.

Embodies the sound of “kaf” through its movement and responds to it sensorially.

Embodies the sound of “dal” through its movement and responds to it sensorially.

Embodies the sound of “ra” through its movement and responds to it sensorially.

Embodies the sound of “lam” through its movement and responds to it sensorially.

Embodies the sound of “nun” through its movement and responds to it sensorially.

Falls silent at the point of the question without distraction.

Names his sensation: “it lengthened,” “it turned,” “it burst.”

Sensory resistance: did he refuse a touch or a movement? (To be documented.)

After the child has lived the prolongation and the first consonants in his body, he moves on to “Completing the Letters and Blending” (the syllabary): the advanced letters, then the first word.